

to avoid any complications. Before accepting the delivery package and signing the bill, you should examine the package carefully to note any possibility of “concealed damages.” Once the shipment bill is signed without any note of possible concealed damages, you become the legal owner of the delivered product and it becomes difficult to claim a refund if the company does not make any provisions for compensation in case of damage during the shipment.



The product does not arrive within the agreed period of time

Most e-commerce sites put up an estimated shipping time figure on product listings, indicating whether the required item is in stock, and if it is, when the product will ship. Even during the course of the delivery, they tend to keep you updated via SMSes, emails and a package tracking code. Despite all of this, if your product takes unusually long to arrive, get in touch with the company to find out what’s going on, and get an update on the shipping status. If you’re dealing with a reputed, large scale e-commerce site, the chances of you being duped are very slim. In the worst case, the site will allow you to withdraw your order and refund your money.

In case of an online marketplace like eBay, where you deal with third party sellers, eBay acts as a middleman, not passing your payment to the seller unless you explicitly state that you’ve received your requested product.

Unreasonable replacement policies

While convincing the seller to allow the return of a product itself can be tricky, there have also been cases where the company expects the customer to handle the charges for shipping back the defective/damaged product. Sometimes, due to items of low value involved, this cost of shipping turns out to be even higher than the cost of product itself.

“Too good to be true” deals

Intense competition in the online shopping industry also means that a few sites might resort to advertising deals that are “too good to be true”, just to